

Post-incident review PIR-2025-042

Identity Platform: stale data shown to users

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 21 February 2025, Identity Platform experienced stale data shown to users in staging (Southeast Asia) for about 25 minutes. A latency threshold alert fired for the service's main endpoint. Investigation found that an upstream identity provider returned intermittent timeouts.

Impact

Users of Identity Platform saw stale data shown to users for about 25 minutes. The service owner, Identity and Access, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:02 First signal received.
- 09:28 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:48 Likely cause identified.
- 10:00 Mitigation applied.
- 10:54 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that an upstream identity provider returned intermittent timeouts.

Certificates were checked as part of triage and were valid.

There was no documented procedure for this failure mode, so responders worked it out live.

It took time to work out which team owned the affected component.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Add a pre-deployment check that validates the setting against the production baseline.
- Exercise the rollback path in staging as part of every release.
- Load test the service at twice the expected peak before the next campaign.